

The introduction should cohesively integrate the background, rationale, problem statement, goals, and preliminary literature review, with literature woven throughout the narrative rather than presented as a separate section.

Outline for Writing the Introduction

I. Introduce the General Topic (Background of the Project)

- Begin with the broad context of the study.
- Introduce the field or discipline.
- Define the key concepts.
- Present current trends, statistics, or conditions.
- Explain the scope of the topic.
- Narrow the discussion from the general issue to the specific area of concern.

Purpose: Help readers understand the context of the study.

II. Establish the Rationale

Explain why the study is necessary.

Discuss:

- Why the issue is important.
- Who is affected.
- Why the issue deserves investigation.
- Why the study is timely.
- Practical and theoretical significance.

Answer the question: Why should this study be conducted?

III. Present the Research Problem

Clearly describe the gap that the project intends to address.

Start with:

- Existing situation
- Desired situation
- Gap between the two
- Consequences if the gap remains unresolved
- Support every major claim using scholarly literature.

Answer the questions:

- What is happening?
- What should be happening?
- What is missing?
- What problem needs solving?

IV. Review Relevant Literature Throughout the Narrative

Rather than creating a separate literature review section, integrate previous studies naturally throughout the introduction.

Include literature that:

- Confirms the existence of the problem.
- Demonstrates the importance of the issue.

- Supports the proposed solution.
- Explains theories related to the study.
- Identifies limitations of previous studies.
- Reveals existing research gaps.
- Shows how the present study differs or improves upon previous work.

The guide recommends using at least 15 scholarly references, with at least 10 published within the last ten years, drawn from peer-reviewed journals and scholarly books.

V. Identify the Research Gap

After discussing previous studies, explain what remains unanswered.

Possible gaps include:

- Context gap
- Population gap
- Methodological gap
- Theoretical gap
- Practical gap
- Technology gap
- Policy gap

Conclude this section by stating how the present study intends to fill the identified gap.

VI. Explain the Proposed Solution

Describe how the project intends to address the identified problem.

Discuss:

- Proposed intervention
- Innovation
- Program
- Framework
- System
- Policy
- Model
- Training
- Educational material

Provide literature supporting why this solution is likely to be effective.

Outline for Writing the Methodology

The methodology should explain **how the project will be conducted**, from planning to evaluation. It should include the project approach, procedures, materials, validation, implementation considerations, and timeline.

I. Methodological Approach

- Identify the capstone option or project type.
- Explain why this approach is appropriate.

II. Project Design

- Describe the overall design or framework.
- Explain how it addresses the identified problem.

III. Project Procedures

Outline the major phases:

- Planning
- Development
- Implementation
- Validation

IV. Materials and Instruments

- Describe the tools, materials, or instruments used.
- Explain how researcher-made instruments will be developed and validated.

V. Validation and Evaluation

- Explain how the project or output will be assessed. (instruments for validation of experts)
- Describe the criteria and methods for measuring effectiveness.

Analysis

- Instruments/questionnaires (ready-made/research-made) (validity/reliability testing)
- Use primary or secondary data
- Information/records from the office
- Statistics / evidence that would prove your claim
- Interview – questions

Design

Develop

- Validation – instrument/questionnaire to be given to the experts.

Implement

Evaluate